▼ GLASSHOUSE

AI FOR ARTIFICIAL INSULT

On September 15, Union minister of culture and tourism **Gajendra Singh Shekhawat** took to social media to lecture the 'Congress IT Cell AI over-enthusiasts' on how artificial intelligence is meant for 'innovation, information and healthy entertainment' and not for 'insult, imitation or intended hurt'. The rebuke was perhaps triggered by a recent AI video, posted by the Bihar Congress, showing Prime Minister **Narendra Modi's** mother visiting him in his dream and admonishing him over playing politics in her name. The social media clip set off a furious row over the slight to the prime minister and his late mother. Fair point: the video was crass, and has rightly invited a legal notice. But Shekhawat's moral policing would carry more weight if he offered the same advice to his own party's IT cell. From **Rahul Gandhi** to Gaurav Gogoi and other leaders, the BJP's online machinery has for years been churning out a steady stream of smear videos packed with innuendo.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ SNOOP STORM

EYE SPY

The Rajasthan assembly monsoon session may have ended, but the uproar over two CCTV cameras near the Opposition benches rages on. Congress state chief Govind Singh Dotasra, boycotting the session after his suspension, accused BJP leader and speaker **Vasudev Devnani** of installing "hidden cameras" accessible only from his anteroom to ogle at the women MLAs. Deputy CM Diya Kumari hit back, calling it proof of Congress's "rotten mentality", while dredging up veteran leader Shanti Dhariwal's defence of rape as "manhood". As the matter escalated, ex-CM Ashok Gehlot demanded a "criminal probe", but Devnani dismissed it, saying the 360-degree cameras were "only for security" and, anyway, audio was switched off.